

The five engines of India's title charge

Here are the top five players who **turned the tide** in India's favour and helped the Men in Blue lift their third title in the shortest format.

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The introduction of Sanju Samson came as a timely intervention for India's floundering top order in this T20 World Cup.

In the first five matches, India's opening partnership averaged 6.80. Samson was not included in the line-up in four of these, with Ishan Kishan and Abhishek Sharma making the cut instead.

In the next four, starting with the Super Eight match against Zimbabwe, that figure shot up to 48.75 as Samson partnered Abhishek up front. Through the Super Eights, only two teams—Pakistan and New Zealand—fared better than this. However, none managed to set the tempo as quickly as India.

In finishing with 321 runs, Samson surpassed Virat Kohli's record from 2014 for the most runs by an Indian in a T20 World Cup edition. Samson's accumulation at a strike rate of 199.37 was only bettered by New Zealand's Finn Allen (200.00).

That his performance was part of a larger redemption arc only made his campaign more memorable.

The Sanju factor

